VOL. I · NO. 2
MORNING EDITION

MUMBAI
EDITED FOR SHARVIN SHAH

The Jarvis Gazette

All the world, before your coffee.

THURSDAY - NOVEMBER 05, 2026 | MUMBAI, INDIA | EDITION NO. 2

₹ Indian Money

STOCK MARKET · COMPANIES · YOUR WALLET

SENSEX	NIFTY 50	GOLD · 10 GRAMS	SILVER · 1 KG	CRUDE OIL · BARREL
77,301	23,961	₹1,43,170	₹1,87,280	$95.08
▲ 0.50%	▲ 0.63%	▲ 2.34%	▲ 3.77%	▼ 8.22%

THE BIG STORY

Five good days in a row, and a two-month high

Indian shares kept climbing on Wednesday. Soap-and-snacks companies, property builders and metal makers led the way, while IT companies were the only group to fall.

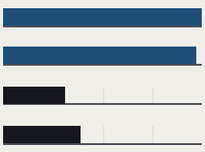
India's stock market rose for the **fifth day running** on Wednesday. The **Sensex** gained 383.55 points to close at 77,301.40, and the **Nifty 50** added 149.75 points to finish at 23,960.60. Both are now at their highest level in about two months.

Wednesday's rise (about half a percent) was gentler than Tuesday's big jump of 1.6%. Think of it like a cricket team that hit a lot of boundaries yesterday and is now taking quick singles: still scoring, just more carefully.

The leaders were **FMCG** companies (everyday goods like soap and biscuits), **realty** companies (builders of flats and offices) and **metal** companies. The media group did best of all. The one group that fell was **IT**, the software-services companies such as TCS and Infosys. Their index dropped more than 1%.

The mood should get another lift this morning. Overnight, oil prices fell more than 8% and US shares jumped, after Americans voted in a new Congress (see pages 2 and 3). Cheaper oil is one of the best things that can happen to India's economy.

ⓘ THE LAST TWO DAYS, SIDE BY SIDE



Still rising, just more slowly. That's normal after a big day.

WHO LED, WHO LAGGED

▲ Media · ▲ FMCG · ▲ Realty · ▲ Metals · ▼ IT (down over 1%)

ⓘ NEW TO THIS? WORDS FROM TODAY'S STORY

Winning streak
Several days in a row when the market closes higher than the day before. Five is a good run.

Sector index
A score for one group of companies, such as IT or banks. It shows which parts of the economy investors like today.

Realty
Short for real estate: companies that build and sell homes, offices and malls.

Dividend
A share of profit that a company pays out in cash to the people who own its shares.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Oil fell below $100 a barrel overnight. If it stays low, petrol, diesel, cooking gas and transport could slowly get cheaper, and so could the things trucks carry. But one analyst firm, Emkay Global, warns that oil risks for India haven't gone away. So enjoy the good news, and don't count on cheaper petrol just yet.

VARSITY-STYLE EXPLAINER: WHY DID IT FALL?

Indian IT companies earn mostly in dollars from foreign clients. Their shares often move on their own news, not on the same things as soap makers or builders. That's why it helps to own a mix of sectors, so one weak group doesn't sink you. (See the money idea on page 9.)

COMPANY NEWS IN BRIEF

RESULTS

NLC India's profit doubles

The government-owned power and lignite company made ₹1,380.67 crore in July–September, up from ₹665.12 crore a year ago. It will pay a dividend of ₹1.50 a share.

RESULTS

NSE earns 23% more

The National Stock Exchange, which runs the Nifty, reported a profit of ₹2,578 crore, up from ₹2,098 crore. Its revenue rose 11%. Busy markets are good business for it.

PRECIOUS METALS

Gold and silver bounce back

Both rebounded sharply on Wednesday. Prices quoted by different jewellers and exchanges varied a lot, so check your local rate before you buy.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Shape tomorrow's paper

Scan with your phone camera to rate today's edition and tell the editor what you want more or less of. Tomorrow's paper reads your answers before it is written.

Or tap here to open the feedback desk

Sources: Zee Business closing bell, 4 Nov · Business Standard, 4 Nov · Telangana Today · Zee Business (NLC) · Upstox (NSE) · StartupTalky (gold, silver; rates vary by source) · Tribune (Emkay). Oil: Brent at the US close. Not investment advice.

World Money

WALL STREET · BIG TECH · OIL · GOLD

THE BIG STORY

America votes, oil crashes, and Wall Street throws a party

The Dow jumped more than 1,500 points in a single day. Here's why an election made oil cheaper and shares dearer.

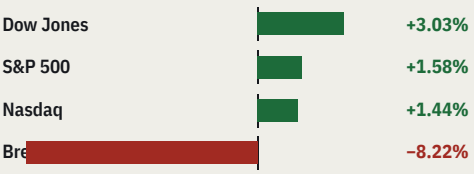
On Wednesday the **Dow Jones**, a score of 30 giant American companies, rose 1,569.40 points, or 3.03%, to 53,356.12. The broader **S&P 500** rose 1.58% to 7,688.62, and the tech-heavy **Nasdaq** rose 1.44% to 25,736.51.

Two things happened together. First, the Democratic Party won control of **both houses of Congress** in Tuesday's midterm elections (page 3). Investors read that as a sign the US may push harder to end its war with Iran. Second, and partly because of that, **oil crashed**. Brent crude, the world's benchmark oil, fell 8.22% to $95.08 a barrel.

Cheaper oil helps almost every business, from airlines to delivery companies, because fuel is one of their biggest costs. It also eases fears of rising prices, which is why the interest rate on US government bonds dipped from 4.95% to 4.89%.

One big name went the other way. After the market closed, chipmaker **Qualcomm**, whose chips are inside many Android phones, beat its own forecasts but warned the coming months could be weaker. A shortage of memory chips is hurting phone makers. Its shares fell sharply in late trading; reports put the drop at between 2% and 8%.

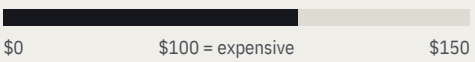
US MARKETS ON WEDNESDAY



Shares up, oil way down. When oil falls this fast, it usually means traders expect more supply soon.

CRUDE OIL (BRENT) PER BARREL

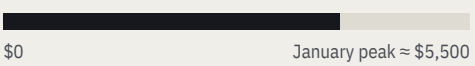
$95.08 ▼ 8.22%



Back under $100 for now. It was near $116 in late October.

GOLD PER OUNCE

above $3,975 ▲ about 1%



A weaker US dollar makes gold cheaper for buyers abroad, so they buy more.

WHY SHOULD SOMEONE IN MUMBAI CARE?

India imports most of the oil it uses, so every $1 drop in the price saves the country a lot of money. A big jump on Wall Street overnight also tends to help Indian shares open higher the next morning. Today is a good day to watch whether the Sensex starts in the green.

JARGON BUSTER

Brent crude
A type of oil from the North Sea whose price is used as the world's main oil price tag.

Midterms
US elections held halfway through a president's four-year term, to choose Congress.

After-hours trading
Buying and selling that happens after the market's normal closing time, often when companies announce results.

Dollar index
A score showing how strong the US dollar is against six other major currencies.

CHIPS

Qualcomm: good results, gloomy forecast

It earned $2.17 a share, just ahead of the $2.16 expected. But the middle of its forecast for next quarter ($2.15–$2.35) sits just below the $2.27 analysts expected, and the memory shortage worries investors.

CURRENCIES

The dollar slips to a five-week low

The dollar index fell to about 101.5. A softer dollar usually helps currencies like the rupee and pushes up gold.

INTEREST RATES

US borrowing costs ease

The 10-year US bond yield fell to 4.89%. Lower yields make loans a little cheaper and shares a little more attractive.

Sources: TheStreet, 4 Nov · JournalArta market close · TradingKey recap · Benzinga (Qualcomm) · InvestingLive · Goodreturns (gold, dollar index) · India News Network (late-Oct oil). Qualcomm's after-hours drop varies by report.

World Affairs

WHO'S DOING WHAT, AND WHY IT MATTERS

THE BIG STORY · UNITED STATES & IRAN

Democrats sweep Congress, and Iran says Americans voted against the war

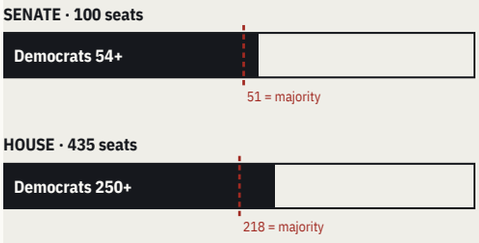
The US president's party lost both houses in Tuesday's elections. Even his own vice president blames the war with Iran.

America's Congress has two halves: the **Senate** (100 members) and the **House of Representatives** (435 members). Before Tuesday, President Trump's Republican Party controlled both. Now the Democrats do. CBS News says Democrats have at least 54 Senate seats, and CNBC projects at least 250 House seats, well past the 218 needed for a majority. A few races are still being counted.

Vice President JD Vance was blunt: "the reason we lost is the war." Trump told the *Financial Times* he had no immediate plans to order new attacks, and reportedly said he would accept the results.

In Tehran, parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, who is also Iran's chief negotiator, wrote: "Americans said NO TO WAR, and we endorse this message." Before the vote, Iran had offered to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within two days if the US accepted seven conditions. But Iran's Supreme Leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, warned that anyone expecting US policy to change is "deeply mistaken", and clashes have continued around the strait.

WHO CONTROLS CONGRESS NOW



Projections; a few races still uncalled.

THE INDIA ANGLE

Analysts quoted by ThePrint say calmer seas in the Gulf could mean **cheaper oil for India**. The catch: a Democratic Congress may also push for tougher punishment of Russia, and India buys a lot of Russian oil. For now, the rules for India's Russian purchases don't change immediately. Prime Minister Modi has already told President Trump that India wants de-escalation and an open Strait of Hormuz.

HOW A VOTE IN AMERICA REACHES YOUR FUEL TANK

1. Voters punish the war	2. Peace looks likelier	3. Oil falls 8%	4. India saves
Congress changes hands	Traders expect Hormuz to reopen	Brent drops below $100	Cheaper imports, if it lasts

AROUND THE WORLD

RUSSIA & UKRAINE

A deadly strike on a small town

The death toll from a Russian attack on Komyshuvakha rose to 40, with more than 30 people possibly still under rubble, President Zelensky said. Fires also broke out in Kyiv after a morning attack.

Why it matters: peace talks are due next week, but the fighting hasn't slowed.

CYBER

A newspaper gets hacked

The *Kyiv Independent*, a major Ukrainian news site, says it was hit by a suspected Russian cyberattack, a first for the outlet.

Why it matters: modern wars are fought on computers as well as battlefields.

EUROPE

Norway guards its Russian border

Norway will send more troops and air-defence sensors to Finnmark, its far-north region that borders Russia.

Why it matters: Russia's neighbours are spending more on defence.

UNITED STATES

Firsts and comebacks

Democrat James Talarico won the Senate race in Texas, and Sherrod Brown won back his old Ohio seat. Hakeem Jeffries could become the first Black Speaker of the House.

Why it matters: the Speaker decides which laws get a vote.

INDIA ABROAD

Jaishankar at the Commonwealth summit

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar represented India at CHOGM 2026 in Antigua and Barbuda, pitching India's digital public infrastructure, like UPI, and its trade agenda.

Why it matters: UPI-style systems are one of India's most popular exports.

COURTS

Duterte's trial gets a date

The International Criminal Court is set to start the trial of former Philippine president Rodrigo Duterte on 30 November, over his deadly war on drugs.

Why it matters: it's rare for a former leader to stand trial abroad.

Sources: CBS News · CNBC · Northeastern · Al Jazeera · PBS · CNN · ThePrint · Kyiv Independent · Newsy Today · Indian Defence News. Seat counts are projections. Ukraine casualty figures are not independently verified.

Defence

ARMY · NAVY · AIR FORCE · MADE IN INDIA

ALL THREE THE BIG STORY

Agniveers get the chance to serve two more years

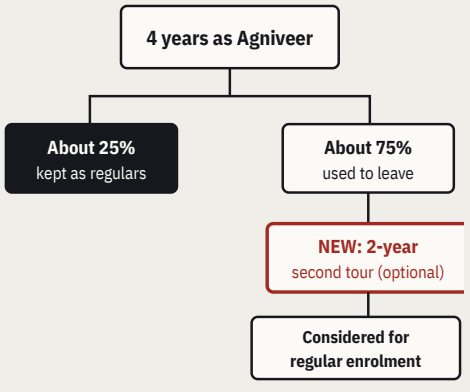
The Union Cabinet changed the four-year Agnipath scheme on Wednesday. Most young soldiers who were due to leave can now stay longer, and may get a shot at a permanent job.

Since 2022, young people have joined the Army, Navy and Air Force as **Agniveers** for four years. At the end, only about a quarter are kept on as regular soldiers. The other three-quarters leave with a lump sum called the **Seva Nidhi**.

Now that 75% gets a new option. If they want to, they can sign up for a **"Second Tour of Duty"** of two more years, with higher pay, a bigger Seva Nidhi package and seniority that keeps adding up. After those two years, everyone who wants to stay will be considered for regular enrolment, based on objective selection criteria.

The government says the change follows a four-year review and advice from the armed forces. The original four-year entry route stays the same. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Home Minister Amit Shah announced it. Supporters called it a win-win; the opposition questioned the timing and called it an election gimmick.

THE NEW PATH, STEP BY STEP



INDIA'S DEFENCE BUDGET, 2026-27

Total	₹7.85 L cr
New kit	₹2.19 L cr

"New kit" is capital outlay: money for new ships, jets, guns and bases. The rest pays salaries, pensions and running costs. Figures as stated by Rajnath Singh.

DRDO MISSILE TEST

A mystery missile flies off Odisha

India test-fired a home-made short-range tactical missile from a test range off the Odisha coast on 3 November. Reports say it was launched from a mobile launcher and tracked all the way. DRDO hasn't said which missile it was. Some reports had expected a test of **Pralay**, a missile that can hit targets roughly 200–500 km away, but that is **not confirmed**.

NAVY BIG IDEAS

The Indo-Pacific Regional Dialogue opens

The Navy's yearly strategy conference began in New Delhi on 3 November. Officers, officials and experts from many countries meet to talk about security at sea in the Indian and Pacific Oceans, where most of India's trade travels.

DEFENCE WORDS DECODED

Agnipath
The scheme, started in 2022, that recruits young soldiers for a fixed term rather than a full career.

Seva Nidhi
"Service fund": the lump sum an Agniveer gets when the term ends, built partly from their own monthly savings.

Tactical missile
A missile meant for the battlefield, with a shorter range than "strategic" missiles that can cross continents.

Capital outlay
Money spent buying long-lasting things, such as new warships, rather than paying day-to-day bills.

WHY IT MATTERS

The biggest worry about Agnipath was simple: what happens to thousands of trained 25-year-olds after four years? This change gives them more time, more money and a real chance at a career in uniform. For the forces, it means keeping experienced soldiers they've already trained, instead of starting over with new recruits.

Sources: Organiser · Asianet Newsable · The NewsMill · Daily Prabhat · Indian Defence News (missile) · SSBCrack, 4 Nov · idrw.org (budget). The missile's identity is unconfirmed.

Sports

CRICKET · HOCKEY · FOOTBALL · F1

CRICKET · INDIA IN NEW ZEALAND · 1ST ODI

Kohli's 74 beats the rain and the Kiwis

Yesterday's paper left India at 54 for 1. Here's how it finished: a five-wicket win, with 56 balls to spare.

After India's bowlers knocked New Zealand over for 185 at Eden Park in Auckland, the rain came. That meant the target was reset using the **DLS method**, a maths formula that works out a fair target when overs are lost.

India got there with plenty to spare, reaching 143 for 5 in 22.4 overs. **Virat Kohli** was the star with 74, steering the chase while wickets fell around him. Arshdeep Singh's four wickets earlier in the day set it all up.

India now lead the five-match series **1–0**. It's a nice follow-up to the T20 series, which India won 3–2 on Sunday even though New Zealand won the last game in Hamilton.

The second ODI is in Wellington on Saturday, 7 November.

EDEN PARK, AUCKLAND · FINAL RESULT

NZ	185 all out
IND	143/5 (22.4 ov)

INDIA WON BY 5 WICKETS (DLS) · SERIES 1–0

F1 DRIVERS' TABLE AFTER MEXICO

Antonelli	380
Verstappen	261
Hamilton	259
Russell	250
Leclerc	245

Antonelli is already champion. The fight now is for second place.

MARK YOUR CALENDAR

- **7 Nov · 2nd ODI v NZ, Wellington**
- **Hockey · India v Japan, Asian Champions Trophy final**
- **Sun · F1 Brazil GP**

SCOREBOARD · CHAMPIONS LEAGUE, WEDNESDAY

HOCKEY · ASIAN CT SEMI		CHAMPIONS LEAGUE		CHAMPIONS LEAGUE	
India	**8**	**Fenerbahçe**	**3**	AEK Athens	2
South Korea	1	Liverpool	2	**Real Madrid**	**3**
CHAMPIONS LEAGUE		CHAMPIONS LEAGUE		CHAMPIONS LEAGUE	
RB Leipzig	2	Slavia Praha	1	**Porto**	**4**
Man City	**3**	**Arsenal**	**2**	Napoli	1

HOCKEY

India hit Korea for eight

India's men beat South Korea 8–1 in the Asian Champions Trophy semi-final in Mohali. They meet Japan, who beat Malaysia in a shootout, in the final.

FOOTBALL

Liverpool's perfect run ends

Liverpool lost for the first time in this season's Champions League, 3–2 at Fenerbahçe in Istanbul. Mason Greenwood led the Turkish side's comeback.

FOOTBALL

Two last-gasp winners

Federico Valverde scored a thunderbolt in stoppage time for Real Madrid at AEK, after Mbappé levelled in the 78th minute. Erling Haaland grabbed a late winner for Manchester City in Leipzig.

RECORD OF THE WEEK

Mercedes driver **Kimi Antonelli** has wrapped up the 2026 Formula 1 title with four races to spare. At 20 years and 68 days, he is the **youngest world champion** in F1 history.

Sources: ESPNcricinfo · Outlook · Yahoo Sports · ESPN (hockey) · UEFA · Yahoo (UCL) · Sky Sports F1 standings · RaceFans

The Reading Room

THREE PIECES OF GREAT WRITING, AND WHAT TO LEARN FROM THEM

Every day we pick three pieces worth your time: one about life, one about work and one about money. We tell you what each says in plain words, and one writing trick you can steal from it.

01

WORK & LIFE | 25 MIN READ

"The Checklist" by Atul Gawande, The New Yorker

In one line: even brilliant experts make simple mistakes, and a humble checklist saves lives.

Gawande, a surgeon, tells the story of a doctor in an American hospital who wrote down five plain steps for putting a tube into a patient's vein: wash your hands, clean the skin, and so on. Everyone already "knew" them. Yet when nurses were allowed to check the steps, infections dropped dramatically. The piece then travels to aviation, where pilots have used checklists since a famous crash in 1935. It later grew into the bestseller *The Checklist Manifesto*.

STEAL THIS TRICK

Open with one person in one moment (a doctor at a bedside), then zoom out to the big idea. Readers follow people first, ideas second.

newyorker.com/magazine/2007/12/10/the-checklist

02

MONEY | 8 MIN READ

"The Three Sides of Risk" by Morgan Housel, Collaborative Fund

In one line: risk isn't just the chance something goes wrong; it's also how often it happens and how bad it is when it does.

Housel, author of *The Psychology of Money*, explains that most people only ask "how likely is a bad outcome?" He argues you also need to ask "how often will it come?" and "how much will it hurt?" A small loss you can survive is very different from one that wipes you out. It's a perfect read on a week when oil prices swung 8% in one night.

STEAL THIS TRICK

Give your idea a number, like "three sides". A clear count tells readers what's coming and helps them remember it.

collabfund.com/blog/the-three-sides-of-risk

03

MONEY · INDIA | 10 MIN READ

"Regulators" by Zerodha Varsity

In one line: the stock market has a referee, SEBI, and knowing what it does makes investing far less scary.

The second chapter of Varsity's first module explains who keeps India's markets fair. It covers SEBI (the Securities and Exchange Board of India), the exchanges like NSE and BSE, and why rules exist to stop insiders from cheating ordinary investors. After reading it, today's NSE result on page 1 will make a lot more sense.

STEAL THIS TRICK

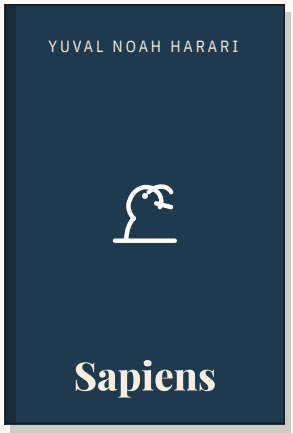
Answer the reader's fear first. Many beginners worry "is this a scam?" Varsity tackles that head-on before teaching anything else.

zerodha.com/varsity/chapter/regulators

Read times are rough estimates. Links go to the original publishers.

The Book Review

TODAY: HISTORY



★★★★☆

Genre: History / big ideas
Published: 2011 (English, 2014)
Length: about 450 pages
Also as: an illustrated graphic version
Read it: one chapter a night

REVIEW · *SAPIENS: A BRIEF HISTORY OF HUMANKIND*

How a not-very-special ape ended up running the planet

Seventy thousand years ago, our species was just one of several kinds of humans, living quietly in a corner of Africa. Today we have rockets, stock markets and the Gazette. How? That's the question this book sets out to answer, and it does so in plain, punchy language you can read on a train.

Harari's big answer is surprising: our superpower is **believing in stories together**. A chimp can't cooperate with a thousand strangers. Humans can, because we share beliefs in things that exist only in our heads, such as gods, nations, companies and money. A ₹500 note is just paper, but because all of us believe in it, it buys dinner.

The book moves fast, from cave painters to farmers, empires, religions, science and capitalism. Some historians say it simplifies too much, and Harari makes bold claims that are really opinions. Read it as a brilliant conversation-starter, not the final word. You'll never look at a rupee note, or a company logo, the same way again.

> *"You could never convince a monkey to give you a banana by promising him limitless bananas after death in monkey heaven."*
>
> Sapiens, chapter 2 · In plain words: only humans cooperate around shared stories, and that changed everything.

THREE BIG IDEAS FROM THE BOOK

1

Stories are our glue

Nations, laws and brands are "shared fictions". They're not fake; they work because millions believe in them at once.

2

Farming was a trap

Harari calls the switch to farming "history's biggest fraud": more food overall, but harder work and worse diets for most people.

3

Money is trust

Money is the most universal story ever told. People who agree on nothing else still accept the same coins.

READ IT IF YOU…

- like big-picture "how did we get here?" questions
- want something smart that doesn't feel like homework
- enjoy books that start arguments at dinner

LIKED IT? READ NEXT

- *Guns, Germs, and Steel* by Jared Diamond
- *Homo Deus* by Harari, about humanity's future
- *The Dawn of Everything* by David Graeber and David Wengrow, which argues with Harari

Puzzles & Games

EIGHT BRAIN GAMES · EASY → HARD · ANSWERS ON PAGE 11

1 · EASY · WORDS

Fruit swap

Rearrange these letters to make a different fruit.

L E M O N

2 · EASY · NUMBERS

What comes next?

Spot the pattern.

3 5 9 17 33 ?

3 · MEDIUM · WORDS

Navy word ladder

Change one letter at a time to turn SHIP into STEP. Every step must be a real word.

SHIP → ? → ? → STEP

4 · MEDIUM · LOGIC

Two pumps

Pump A fills a water tank in 6 hours. Pump B fills the same tank in 3 hours. If both run together, how long does it take to fill the tank?

5 · MEDIUM · GRID

Mini Sudoku

Fill in the grid so every row, column and 2×2 box has 1, 2, 3 and 4.

2			3
	3		
		3	
	2	1	

6 · MEDIUM · TODAY'S NEWS

Wall Street maths

The Dow rose 1,569.40 points on Wednesday to close at 53,356.12. Where did it close on Tuesday?

7 · HARD · NUMBERS

The mystery number

I'm a three-digit number. My digits add up to 12. My first digit is twice my last digit. Flip me backwards and I become 396 smaller. Who am I?

8 · HARD · WORDPLAY

Read the picture

What sailor's cry does this show?

MAN
BOARD

Hint: where is the man?

Facts, Figures & Takes

THINGS TO SAY AT LUNCH

1,569

Points the Dow Jones gained in a single day after the US elections.

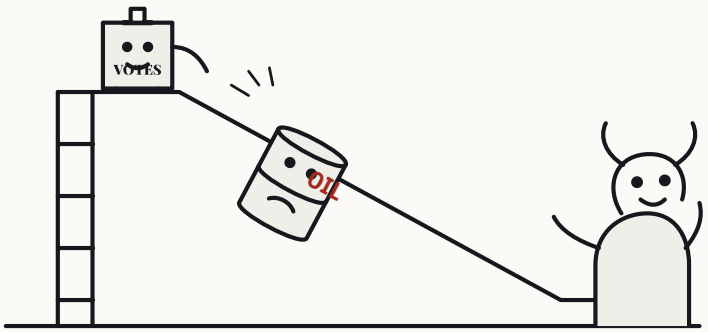
8.22%

How much the price of a barrel of Brent oil fell overnight, to $95.08.

20 yrs 68 days

Kimi Antonelli's age as F1's youngest-ever world champion.

POCKET CARTOON



"Nobody told me the ballot box could push."

THE TAKE · OUR OPINION

A vote in America just moved the price of your petrol

On Tuesday, millions of Americans voted. By Wednesday night, oil had fallen 8%, India's markets were on a five-day winning streak and Wall Street had one of its biggest days of the year. It's a reminder of how connected the world is: a ballot in Ohio can change the cost of a bus ride in Mumbai.

But notice the word traders used: **hopes**. Nothing has actually changed in the Strait of Hormuz yet. Iran's Supreme Leader says US policy won't shift, and clashes continue. Oil fell on expectations, and expectations can flip in a day.

Our view: celebrate cheaper oil when it shows up at the petrol pump, not before. Markets price in good news early; real life takes longer.

This is the Gazette's opinion, not financial advice.

MONEY IDEA OF THE DAY: DON'T PUT ALL YOUR EGGS IN ONE BASKET

On Wednesday, FMCG, property and metal shares rose, while IT shares fell. If all your money had been in IT, you'd have had a bad day in a good market.

Spreading your money across many kinds of companies is called **diversification**. An index fund, like a Nifty 50 fund, does it for you automatically: one purchase gives you a slice of 50 companies across many industries.

DID YOU KNOW?

Sea otters hold hands

When they sleep on the water, sea otters often hold paws so they don't drift apart.

Lightning is hotter than the Sun

A lightning bolt can reach about 30,000°C, roughly five times hotter than the surface of the Sun.

The shortest war lasted under an hour

Britain and Zanzibar fought in 1896. Zanzibar surrendered after about 38 to 45 minutes.

Indian Railways is a giant employer

It employs over 1.2 million people, making it one of the largest employers in the world.

A flamboyance of flamingos

That's the real name for a group of flamingos. Their pink colour comes from the shrimp and algae they eat.

Zero came from India

Indian mathematician Brahmagupta wrote down rules for using zero as a number in 628 AD.

Figures from pages 2, 3 and 5. Facts from standard reference works.

Ten Words for Today

LEARN THEM, THEN USE ONE BEFORE DINNER

1 **Mercurial** adj. · mur-KYOOR-ee-ul
Changing mood or direction suddenly and often.
"Oil prices have been mercurial all week."

2 **Cogent** adj. · KOH-junt
Clear, logical and convincing.
"She made a cogent case for an index fund."

3 **Pyrrhic** adj. · PIR-ik
Describes a victory that costs so much it's almost a defeat.
"Winning the argument but losing the client was a Pyrrhic victory."

4 **Reticent** adj. · RET-i-sunt
Not willing to say much about your thoughts or feelings.
"DRDO stayed reticent about which missile it tested."

5 **Zeitgeist** noun · ZYTE-guyst
The mood and spirit of a particular time.
"The election results captured the zeitgeist: people are tired of war."

6 **Ebullient** adj. · ih-BUL-yunt
Bubbling over with energy and excitement.
"Traders were ebullient as the Dow soared."

7 **Juxtapose** verb · JUK-stuh-pohz
To place two things side by side to show how different they are.
"The chart juxtaposes falling oil with rising shares."

8 **Truculent** adj. · TRUK-yuh-lunt
Eager to argue or fight; aggressive.
"His truculent tone ended the meeting early."

9 **Serendipity** noun · ser-un-DIP-i-tee
Finding something good by happy accident.
"Meeting her co-founder at a wedding was pure serendipity."

10 **Hubris** noun · HYOO-bris
Too much pride or self-confidence, the kind that leads to a fall.
"Ignoring the checklist was surgical hubris."

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Use **one** of these words naturally in a conversation or email today. Words stick when you use them, not when you just read them.

Skill of the Day

IN THE KITCHEN · ABOUT 40 MINUTES (MOSTLY WAITING) · DIFFICULTY: EASY

IN THE KITCHEN · AS PROMISED YESTERDAY

How to cook fluffy rice in a regular pot

No pressure cooker, no whistles, no sticky mush. This is the "absorption method": the rice drinks up exactly the right amount of water and steams itself perfect.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

1 cup basmati rice	1½ cups water	Pot with a tight lid	Salt, a little ghee, a fork

1 Rinse

Put the rice in a bowl, cover with water, swirl with your hand and pour the cloudy water away. Repeat 3–4 times until the water is almost clear. This washes off loose starch, the main cause of sticky rice.

2 Soak

Cover the rinsed rice with fresh water and leave it for 20–30 minutes. Then drain it well. Soaked grains cook evenly and grow long instead of breaking.

3 Measure the water

For 1 cup of soaked basmati, use about 1½ cups of water. (Skipped soaking? Use about 1¾ cups.) Use the same cup for rice and water.

4 Boil

Put the water, a pinch of salt and half a teaspoon of ghee or oil in the pot and bring it to a boil. Add the drained rice and stir once, gently.

5 Cover and turn it right down

When it bubbles again, put the lid on tight and turn the flame to its lowest. Set a timer for 12 minutes.

Don't lift the lid

; you'll let the steam out.

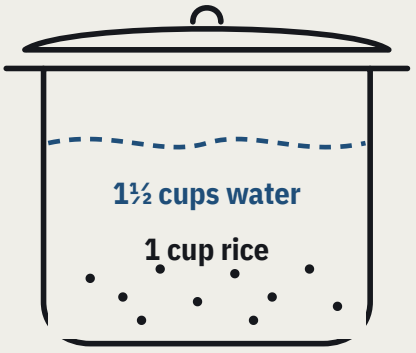
6 Rest

Turn off the flame and leave the pot covered for 10 more minutes. The rice finishes cooking in its own steam.

7 Fluff

Open the lid and gently lift and separate the grains with a fork. Don't stir with a spoon, which mashes them.

THE MAGIC RATIO



Old trick: water should sit about one finger-joint above the rice. Ratios vary a little with the rice, so note what works in your pot.

⚠ SAFETY FIRST

- Lift the lid **away from you**: trapped steam can burn your face and hands.
- Don't leave the pot alone on a high flame; it can boil over and put out a gas flame.
- Cool leftover rice quickly and put it in the fridge within about an hour. Rice left out for hours can make you ill.

PRO TIP

Burnt smell at the bottom? Your flame was too high. Next time use the smallest burner, or put a flat tawa under the pot to spread the heat.

Tomorrow's skill: how to tie a neat necktie with the four-in-hand knot, in under a minute.

PUZZLE ANSWERS (PAGE 8) · TURN THE PAPER UPSIDE DOWN

1. MELON · 2. 65 (double, then subtract 1) · 3. SHIP → SHOP → STOP → STEP · 4. 2 hours (A fills ⅓ of the tank an hour, B fills ⅓, together ⅔) · 5. Rows: 2 1 4 3 / 4 3 2 1 / 1 4 3 2 / 3 2 1 4 · 6. 51,786.72 · 7. 804 (8+0+4 = 12; 804 − 408 = 396) · 8. MAN OVERBOARD ("man" over "board")